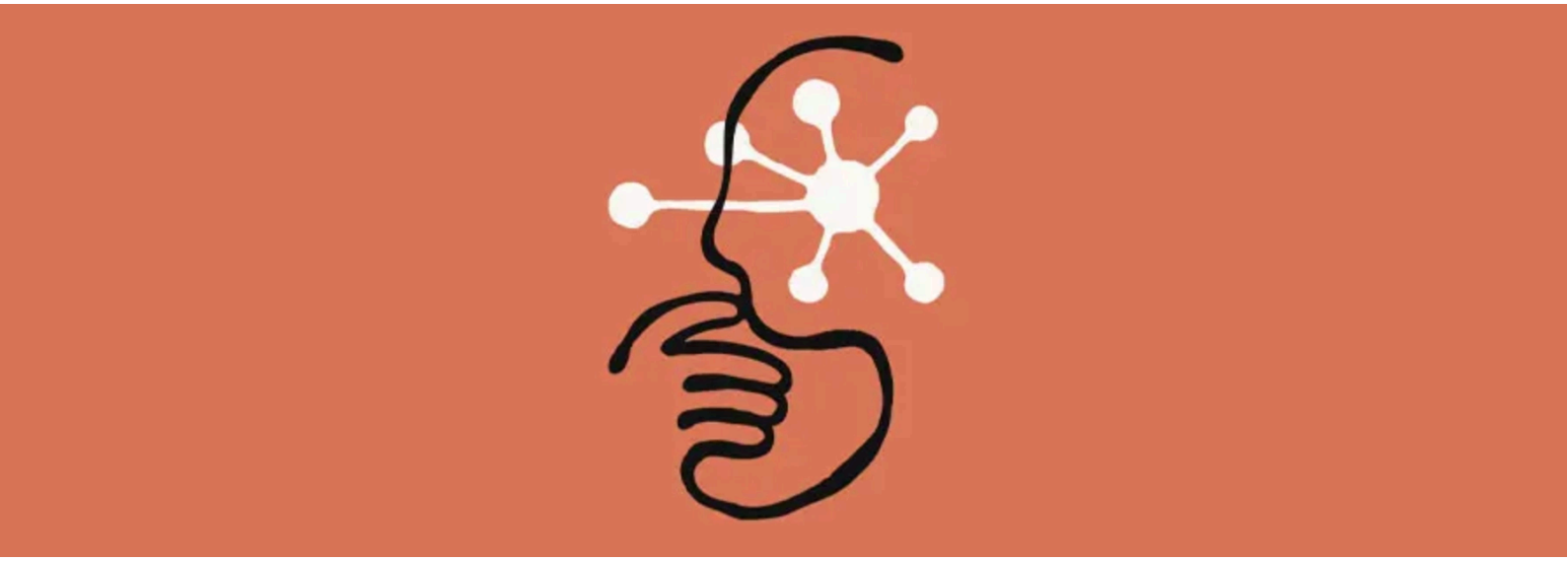

How I Used Claude Cowork to Reverse-Engineer My Competitors' Google Rankings and Add $25k in 30 Days.

The 7-Prompt Playbook for SEO Domination

📑 Table of Contents

1. **Part 1: The Problem With Local SEO** — Why the agency model is broken
2. **Part 2: The Method** — Pattern extraction, not magic
3. **Part 3: The 7-Prompt Stack** — The exact scripts that generated $25k
4. **Part 4: The 30-Day Execution Calendar** — Week-by-week implementation
5. **Part 5: Before and After** — Reading your results
6. **Part 6: The Operator's Playbook** — Key principles for consistency

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💀 Part 1: The Problem With Local SEO

The Agency Tax

Local SEO is a scam.

Most agencies charge you $2,500 a month to post grainy stock photos and generic captions that nobody reads. It is a tax on the uninformed.

They follow a "Best Practices" checklist from 2019. You pay for "maintenance" while your competitors steal your leads. The "Top 10 Tips" you find on YouTube are useless.

Why Generic Strategies Fail

Google's algorithm isn't a single entity. It is a localized, shifting set of weights that change based on your zip code and your specific keyword.

If you optimize for "Plumber in Dallas" using a "Plumber in Miami" strategy, you lose. Most operators are optimizing blind. They guess. They hope. They wait.

> The ROI Operator doesn't guess.

The Agency Trap

The agency model works like this:

- High monthly retainers for low-impact work.
- Generic "Keyword Research" that ignores local intent.
- Zero transparency on what is actually moving the needle.

You don't need a 40-page report. You need to know why the guy in the #1 spot is there.

Is it his review velocity? Is it his photo cadence? Is it the specific way he clusters service keywords in his replies?

Standard SEO tools won't tell you. They show you backlinks and domain authority. Google Maps doesn't care about your domain authority as much as it cares about **local relevance signals.**

The Real Issue

If you follow a generic checklist, you are building a house with a blindfold on. You are wasting capital on "Optimization" that doesn't trigger the algorithm.

The real issue: You have no data on what Google actually rewards for YOUR keyword in YOUR market.

This guide is for the SaaS founders, agency owners, and consultants who need local dominance. It is for the people who want to stop being victims of the algorithm.

We are shifting the mindset. Stop following checklists. Start extracting patterns.

I labored for months testing these prompts so you don't have to. I audited the failures. I doubled down on the wins.

> This is how we stop guessing. This is how we start winning.

🔬 Part 2: The Method — Pattern Extraction, Not Magic

Claude Cowork as a Revenue Machine

I used Claude Cowork to build a revenue machine.

Claude Cowork isn't just a chatbot. It is a browser-enabled agent that sees what Google sees. Most SEO tools give you metrics. Metrics don't tell you why a competitor ranks #1 with zero backlinks. Patterns do.

The Core Loop

The process is simple:

- Point Claude at your top 3 competitors.
- Extract the specific ranking triggers Google rewards in your city.
- Execute those patterns manually.

This kills the "I think this works" mindset. It replaces it with **"I know this works because it's already winning."**

Why This Beats Ahrefs or SEMrush for Local SEO

- Standard tools show you global data. Claude Cowork audits **live browser data.**
- Standard tools show you "What." Claude Cowork shows you **"How."**

We are performing **Pattern Extraction.** We are looking for the outliers. We are finding the businesses that rank high despite having weak branding. Those businesses are the gold mine. They are ranking because they accidentally hit a dominant ranking signal. We find that signal. We isolate it. We crush them with it.

The Anti-Hype Disclaimer

Claude Cowork does not rank you. The prompts do not rank you. **You rank you.**

> AI gives you the blueprint. Execution does the work. If you get the blueprint and don't upload the photos, you stay at the bottom.

We use Claude to identify:

- Review volume and velocity targets.
- Exact keyword themes for post content.
- Photo upload frequency that triggers "Freshness" signals.
- Category relevance that competitors are exploiting.

This is surgical SEO. We aren't spray-painting the internet with content. We are injecting the exact signals Google is already looking for.

What You Need to Start

To start the GBP Stack, you need three things:

- **Claude Cowork** (The Max plan for browser access).
- **3 Competitor URLs** (The ones currently beating you).
- **Your Google Business Profile access.**

If you have those, you have a $25k revenue engine. Stop looking for "hacks." Start extracting the data.

🎯 Part 3: The 7-Prompt Stack

The Engine

Most people use AI to write bad poems. You will use it to **extract profit.**

These 7 prompts are the exact sequence used to generate **$25k in revenue.** They do not "do SEO." They **identify the math** behind the rankings.

Copy them. Paste them. **Execute the output.**

Prompt 1: The Competitive Auditor

The Problem: You have zero data on where you stand against the current market leaders.

Requirement: Claude Cowork with browser access.

```
> Loading JavaScript code...
```

How To Read The Output:

Look for **service gaps.** If every competitor lists "Emergency 24/7 Repair" and you don't, you are invisible to that buyer. Look for trust signals you lack. Ignore the "friendly" tone. Focus on the hard data points.

Why It Works: This forces Claude to build a data foundation. It stops the AI from guessing and starts the process of market analysis.

> Ensure your website URL is the direct landing page linked to your GBP. Accuracy drives ROI.

Prompt 2: The Lever Extractor

The Problem: You don't know which ranking factors actually matter for your specific keyword in your specific city.

Requirement: Competitive data from Prompt 1.

```
> Loading JavaScript code...
```

How To Read The Output:

Focus on the **Impact Rank.** If "Review Velocity" is #1, stop worrying about your description. If "Keyword in Business Name" is #1, you know the competitive environment is aggressive. Ignore any generic advice Claude tries to slip in. Demand the table.

Why It Works: This eliminates guesswork. It forces Claude to find the causation behind the rankings.

> If Claude gives you a list instead of a table, tell it: "Format as a table. Now." Be the boss.

Prompt 3: The Content Blueprint

The Problem: You are guessing what to post on your GBP. Your content strategy is random.

Requirement: Claude Cowork with browser access.

```
> Loading JavaScript code...
```

How To Read The Output:

Look for the **Frequency** and **CTA style.** If winners post 3x a week with "Call Now" buttons, do that. If they use "Before and After" photos, start taking more photos. Ignore "be creative." Focus on the pattern.

Why It Works: This reverses the content strategy of the winners. It tells you exactly what to post to stay relevant.

> Most GBPs are ghost towns. Even a basic frequency of 2x per week usually beats 90% of local businesses. Consistency is the moat.

Prompt 4: The Pattern Recognizer

The Problem: You can't see the minimum requirements to enter the top 3 for your keyword.

Requirement: Competitive data from Prompts 1–3.

```
> Loading JavaScript code...
```

How To Read The Output:

Pay attention to **Categories.** If all three competitors use "HVAC Contractor" but you use "Air Conditioning Repair," you might be in the wrong bucket. Look at the photo count. If they all have 200+ photos and you have 10, you have a workload problem, not an SEO problem.

Why It Works: This is pure data extraction. It strips away the fluff and shows the technical skeleton of a winning profile.

> The Primary Category is the most powerful toggle in the GBP dashboard. If the patterns show a different category than yours, change it immediately.

Prompt 5: The Outlier Hunter

The Problem: You don't know which "rules" can be broken to win fast in your market.

Requirement: Competitive data from Prompts 1–4.

```
> Loading JavaScript code...
```

How To Read The Output:

Look for the **Dominant Factor.** If a guy with 5 reviews is ranking #2, find out why. Is it his location? Is it his keyword-rich name? This tells you which "rule" you can break to win fast.

Why It Works: This finds the loopholes. It identifies businesses that are punching above their weight and reveals the strongest ranking signal in your specific local market.

> Outliers are the roadmap to shortcuts. If branding doesn't matter for your keyword, don't waste money on a new logo. Spend on what ranks.

Prompt 6: The Review Engineer

The Problem: Your reviews are random. You have no system for turning social proof into a keyword engine.

Requirement: Claude Cowork with browser access.

```
> Loading JavaScript code...
```

How To Read The Output:

Look for the **Recurring Keywords.** These are the words your customers need to use in their reviews. Look at the Reply Patterns. If winners include "City Name" and "Service Name" in their replies, copy that system.

Why It Works: This turns reviews into a keyword engine. It analyzes how customers talk and how winners reply.

> Do not just ask for "a review." Ask customers to "mention the [Service] we did in [City]." This feeds the algorithm exactly what it wants.

Prompt 7: The Visual Strategist

The Problem: Your photos are confusing Google's image recognition AI about what your business actually does.

Requirement: Claude Cowork with browser access.

```
> Loading JavaScript code...
```

How To Read The Output:

Look for **Photo Types.** If the winners have 50 "Job-site" photos and you have 50 "Office" photos, you are confusing the AI. Follow the Upload Cadence strictly. If the plan says 5 photos a week, do 5 photos a week.

Why It Works: Google uses image recognition (Cloud Vision) to understand your business. This prompt ensures your visual data matches what Google wants to see for your industry.

> Use real photos. Stock photos are zero-value assets. They do not help you rank. They do not build trust. Delete them.

Summary of the System

These 7 prompts are not a "one-and-done" task. This is a **monthly audit.**

Markets change. Competitors get lazy. New players enter.

- Run the stack.
- Extract the data.
- Update the plan.
- Execute.

> This is how you turn a profile into a revenue machine. Stop guessing. Start operating.

📅 Part 4: The 30-Day Execution Calendar

Stop Thinking. Start Doing.

The GBP Stack is a machine. If you don't turn the crank, the machine stays cold. Follow this timeline. No deviations.

Week 1: Audit and Foundation

Phase one is the **Clean Up.** You cannot build on a broken base.

- Run **Prompts 1 through 5** from the previous section.
- Open a blank doc. Call it your **Competitor Pattern Document.**
- List exactly what the top 3 players are doing.
- Fix your **GBP Basics:**
- Audit your **Primary Category.** Is it the highest volume?
- Rewrite your **Business Description.** Pack it with Local Intent.

- Verify your **Hours and Attributes.** Missing info is a lost signal.

Week 2: Content and Reviews

Phase two is the **Signal Boost.** Google needs to see your profile is alive.

- Start your **Posting Cadence.** Use the output from Prompt 3.
- Post 3 times this week.
- Launch the **Review Acquisition Framework** from Prompt 6.
- Text your last 10 happy customers.
- Write your first batch of **Owner Replies** using Keyword-Optimized templates.
- Do not just say "Thanks." Mention the **Service** and the **City.**

Week 3: Photos and Signals

Phase three is **Visual Authority.** People buy with their eyes. Google reads the data behind the image.

- Execute the **Photo Upload Plan** from Prompt 7.
- Upload 5 high-quality images of your work.
- Upload 2 images of your team or office.
- Check your **Review Pacing.** Ensure new reviews are hitting the profile every 48 hours.
- Keep the **Posting Cadence** active.

Week 4: Measure and Iterate

Phase four is the **Optimization Loop.** Data tells the truth. Feelings don't.

- Re-run **Prompts 1 and 2.**
- Compare your current visibility to Day 1.
- Look at your **Map Pack Position.**
- Identify which keywords moved the needle.
- Double down on the content that worked.
- Cut the dead weight.

The 5-Minute Daily Routine

Do this every morning before checking email.

- Check for new reviews.

- Reply to all reviews using **Keyword-Rich** templates.
- Check for **Customer Questions.** Answer them instantly.
- Post one update (if scheduled for today).

The 30-Minute Weekly Routine

Do this every Friday afternoon.

- Upload 3 new photos from your phone.
- Review **Search Insights.** See what terms found you.
- Send 5 review requests to new customers.
- Audit your competitors. Did they change their Primary Category?

📊 Part 5: Before and After — Reading Your Results

Numbers Don't Lie

Numbers don't lie. But most people look at the wrong ones.

Ignore "Views." Views are vanity. Focus on **Conversion Signals.**

What to Measure

- **Map Pack Position:** Are you in the Top 3 for your main service?
- **GBP Impressions:** How many times did your pin show up on a map?
- **Calls:** Hard leads.
- **Direction Requests:** High-intent local traffic.

How to Pull GBP Insights

1. Log into your Google Business Profile.
2. Click **Performance.**
3. Select the **30-Day Window.**
4. Export the data to a spreadsheet.
5. Compare it to your Baseline.

Realistic Expectations

This is not a magic trick. It is an **Algorithm Play.**

In the first 30 days, you will see "ghost" movements. You might jump to #2, then drop to #5. This is Google testing your Relevance. Stay the course.

> The real ROI hits at the 60 and 90-day marks.

The Benchmark Template

Metric	Day 1	Day 30	Change (%)
:---	:---	:---	:---
Map Position (Main Term)	#12	#4	+66%
Total Phone Calls	10	18	+80%
Direction Requests	5	12	+140%
Total Reviews	45	52	+15%

The Monthly Cadence

Run the **Full Stack** every 30 days. The market moves. Competitors wake up. If you stop, you drop.

> Consistency is the only Competitive Advantage that lasts.

🛡️ Part 6: The Operator's Playbook — Key Principles

The Philosophy

AI gave you the map. Execution did the work.

The GBP Stack is a tool, not a savior. An operator knows that **Systems beat Talent** every time.

The 3 Rules of the Stack

1. **Audit What Works:** If a specific photo gets 1,000 views, post more like it.
2. **Define Done:** Don't spend 4 hours on a post. Use the prompt. Post it. Move on.
3. **Stay Consistent:** One post a month is a hobby. Three posts a week is a **Business.**

Who This Works For

- **Local Businesses:** Plumbers, Lawyers, Roofers, Dentists.
- **Agencies:** If you run SEO for clients, this is your Standard Operating Procedure.

Who This Does Not Work For

- **E-commerce:** No physical location? No GBP.
- **National Brands:** No local intent? No Map Pack.

Closing Statement

You have the prompts. You have the 30-day calendar. You have the metrics.

The Arbitrage is sitting right in front of you. Your competitors are lazy. They think "setting it and forgetting it" works. It doesn't.

> Run the stack today. Measure the ROI in 30 days. Get to work.

The GBP Stack — a LeadPanther framework for local SEO domination.